

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 132

By Bulso

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize Raul Lopez and Men of Valor.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those estimable organizations and their respective leaders who are devoted to improving the lives of people in this State; and

WHEREAS, for almost fifteen years, Raul Lopez has served as the executive director of Men of Valor, a prison ministry operating in Middle and East Tennessee that is committed to helping the incarcerated and the formerly incarcerated reconcile with their families, society, and Creator; and

WHEREAS, under Mr. Lopez's leadership, the Men of Valor ministry has contributed to Tennessee's declining recidivism rate, saving the State millions of dollars while tackling the viciousness of intergenerational incarceration in society and our local communities; and

WHEREAS, a recognized Latino leader in Tennessee, Raul Lopez is a political refugee from Cuba who has lived in various states during his lifetime but has called Middle Tennessee home for more than thirty years. He has immersed himself in his local church and community and sought ways to improve the lives of others; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Lopez's experience living under a communist regime has fueled his passion for fighting for liberty and freedom, particularly among Tennessee's growing Latino community; and

WHEREAS, at a time when Tennessee's Latino community is growing and flexing its cultural, political, and economic muscle, it is vital that we recognize a Latino leader like Raul Lopez for his many contributions; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend Raul Lopez and Men of Valor for their many contributions to the State of Tennessee, extending our deepest gratitude for the organization's important work and our best wishes for its continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.